Prompts

- A prompt is the input text you feed to an LLM
  - How much wood could a
  - How many meters are in a mile?
- The LLM then predicts the next word, repeatedly, until the predicted next word is [EOS]
- Some prompts will get better responses than others!
  - Why?

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Prompt Engineering

- Can we write a prompt that is more likely to get a good response?
  - YES: Prompt engineering!

- Can we guarantee a perfect answer by engineering a prompt?
  - NO!

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Prompt Engineering

- Control model behavior
- Get constrained outputs
- Higher output quality
- Automate operations

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Prompt Engineering Limitations

- High sensitivity
- Common sense
- Exception handling
- Debugging

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Prompt Engineering

- Template
  - Translate this sentence from English to Spanish:
- Fill in the blank
  - The first person to walk on the moon was ____
- Multiple choice
  - Which of the 3 options below is correct?

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Prompt Engineering

- Instructional
  - Write a neutral-tone sales pitch in 300 words for a pair of socks
- Iterative
  - Start with a broad prompt and narrow it based on LLM's output
- Ethically aware
  - LLMs may avoid answering certain questions

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